

Many US military observers were puzzled when they noticed how the North Vietnamese soldiers and the Viet Cong guerrillas seemed to fight with more determination than the ARVN. As the war progressed, the South Vietnamese forces became increasingly dependent upon American support. The continuous supply of replacement parts and new equipment, and the availability of massive air support when needed paradoxically seemed to inhibit the resourcefulness and self-reliance of the Southerners. Nevertheless, many ARVN officers and troops fought effectively during the multipronged Tet Offensive of 1968 and then in the Easter Offensive of 1972. They also offered strong resistance during the final chapter of the war in April 1975.

It has often been observed that, in combat, soldiers in all armies fight for one another above all else. It is clear that the ARVN fought to protect their homes and families more than for the government. Some 200,000 ARVN soldiers died during the conflict.

» AFTER

When South Vietnam lost the war in 1975, the soldiers in the ARVN lost the country for which they had been drafted to fight.

THE FATE OF THE ARVN

When the victorious North assumed control of South Vietnam in April 1975, some conscripted soldiers of the ARVN **returned to their villages**. Decades after the end of the war, the families of those who supported the government of the South were subject to restrictions.

RE-EDUCATION

Anyone who held any degree of command responsibility was sent to a **re-education camp**, where many died in the harsh and dangerous conditions.